

Post-incident review PIR-2025-009

Order Management: elevated error rates

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 08 November 2025, Order Management experienced elevated error rates in production (AU East) for about 25 minutes. The error-rate alert paged the on-call engineer. Investigation found that an external payment processor changed its response format without warning.

Impact

Users of Order Management saw elevated error rates for about 25 minutes. The service owner, Commerce Platform, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:05 First signal received.
- 09:29 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:46 Likely cause identified.
- 10:23 Mitigation applied.
- 10:41 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that an external payment processor changed its response format without warning. The expected load had not been tested before release.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Add a pre-deployment check that validates the setting against the production baseline.
- Add a synthetic probe that exercises the affected path every minute.
- Assign a named owner for the component in the service catalogue.